

Quick Tips:

CRAFTING A CAREER SUMMARY



Heading



Sentence 1



Sentence 2



Sentence 3

WHAT IS A CAREER SUMMARY? A career summary is a short paragraph - usually three to five sentences long - that summarizes your background and describes your "brand", or unique selling points, to recruiters, hiring managers, and people who are passing along your resume. Summary statements are used at the **top of your resume** (usually in place of an objective statement), on your **LinkedIn profile** (under "Summary"), on your **iMPact profile** and less formal versions can be adapted for use in **networking emails**.

WHY DO I NEED ONE? A career summary is valuable for students whose past work experience does not convey a clear message about their future career targets. The summary sets the tone for the audience's overall understanding, as it allows professionals to view their experience through a self-prescribed "lens." The process of writing a career summary can be inherently valuable and help students develop a much clearer understanding of their brand and value proposition, and how to communicate it to their target companies.

ARE THERE DIFFERENCES FOR USE IN RESUME, LINKEDIN AND EMAILS? For on-campus job searches, the Ross iMPact format does not have a summary section but for students doing an off-campus search, a summary can be used on your resume. A resume will use the most formal language and will not include any personal pronouns. Summaries on LinkedIn can range from formal to informal and "I" statements are acceptable if choosing an informal tone. Key phrases in your career summary can be used in networking emails, but should be considered in a situation-by-situation basis to ensure appropriate tone.

HOW DO I WRITE ONE? Follow the steps below. Write your summary AFTER you have gone through the self-assessment phase, identified your motivated strengths (skills you enjoy using) and determined your career focus. Revisit your career summary after you've completed your resume to make sure you haven't skipped any essential skills.



HEADLINE



Job seekers should take advantage of this prime real estate in LinkedIn to say more about their brand. Give yourself a custom title based on your target function or industry. You can use subtitles to reflect key skills related to your function or industry expertise. This headline must reflect actual skills or experience (not just an aspirational title). Job seekers who are focused in several possibly divergent areas tend to create a more general headline in a LinkedIn profile, and create several customized resumes highlighting key terms for those functions or industries.

Sample Headlines (typically use one, but can be used in multiples):

Experienced Marketing Professional; MBA Candidate; Cleantech Business Development

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01 SENTENCE ONE

Sentence one is a broad statement describing your work functions performed and industry experience.

Sample Openings for Sentence One:

- Ross MBA with achievement in procurement and merchandising for Fortune 500 retailers.
- Marketing professional with three years experience in the managed health care industry.
- Operations manager with broad-based manufacturing experience ranging from basic engineering to supply chain and total program management at the divisional level.
- Highly committed human resources professional with experience in direct service, supervision, and compliance regulations



02 SENTENCE TWO



Sentence two describes your "brand," or the skills that have led to your most significant achievements. Pair one of the sample phrases below with your overarching brand/value proposition statement. Don't use any personal pronouns on your resume version. **Sample Lead-ins:**

Special expertise in...
In-depth knowledge of...
Broad expertise in...
Strong knowledge in...
Expert skills in...
Knowledgeable in all aspects of...
Highly regarded for...
Acquired proficiency in...
Demonstrated success in...
A strong sense of...

Demonstrated ability to...
A strong track record in...
A history of...
Reputation as a...
Go the extra mile to...
Gained expertise for...
Earned high marks for...
Highly skilled in...
Known for being...
Areas of expertise include...

03 SENTENCE THREE

Sentence three lists additional skills, soft skills, and/or personal values that you can offer to an employer. Avoid phrases that sound cliché, if possible. You can draw inspiration from looking at past performance reviews, where team members have described your strengths. Also look at career assessment results, such as CareerLeader or MBTI for ideas. Cross-reference these soft skills/values against fit characteristics for functions/industries you're targeting. **Sample Statements:**

- Leader, coach, and mentor valued for inspiring teams to exceed targets.
- Exemplary communication skills, both written and verbal.
- Creative problem solver who consistently achieves results.
- Process-focused leader dedicated to continuous improvement.
- Strong interpersonal skills.
- Effective speaker, writer, and rapport builder.
- Consensus-builder able to establish and leverage relationships across the organization to promote change.
- Disciplined work habits, rigorous commitment to quality.
- Highly ambitious, goal-directed and quality conscious.
- High energy, strong take-charge ability and follow-through.



NOTE: A skills list is optional, and typically consists of a bulleted list of key words, phrases, or accomplishments, ordered by those skills most relevant to your career objective. Lead-in phrases: "Competencies Include:", "Areas of Expertise Include:", or "Experience In:"